

IAN FLETCHER

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Department of Economics, University of Wyoming, Laramie, WY 82071

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, University of Wyoming

Expected May 2027

Dissertation: Decisions under Risk, Uncertainty, and Intangibility

Committee: Todd Cherry (chair), George Loewenstein, David Finnoff, Linda Thunström, Jacob Hochard

M.Sc., Economics, University of Wyoming

May 2024

B.S., Mathematics and Economics; Honors Minor, University of Wyoming

May 2022

Additional Training

Participant, Russell Sage Foundation Summer Institute in Behavioral Economics, Harvard University

(Jun–Jul 2026)

Participant, The Chicago School in Experimental Economics, University of Chicago

(Aug 2024)

Visiting Doctoral Student, University of Chicago, Prof. John List

(Jun–Aug 2024)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied microeconomics at the intersection of behavioral, environmental, and public economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Fletcher, Ian M. (2026) The Intangibility of Risk Reduction under Heterogeneous Risk: Theory and Experimental Evidence

Summary: *Prevention is chronically underfunded relative to disaster response, even when it yields higher expected returns. I propose that prevention suffers a curse of intangibility: its successes are hard to detect or to attribute to the actions that produced them. In a model where people judge an investment's efficacy from realized outcomes rather than their causes, an unattributable no-disaster leads to overinvestment, and an unattributable loss leads to underinvestment. A 2×2 laboratory experiment varying baseline risk and outcome attributability confirms both predictions. Because probabilities are held fixed across treatments, risk and ambiguity preferences cannot explain the pattern. Sustaining support for prevention may require rewarding predicted rather than realized outcomes.*

PUBLICATIONS

Hubbard, Chandler, **Ian M. Fletcher**, Todd L. Cherry, David Finnoff, and Jacob Hochard. (2025) The public overestimates and prefers greater tolerance for grizzly bear encounters than defined by the United States management guidelines. *Communications Earth & Environment* 6, 1022.

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

Carattini, Stefano, **Ian M. Fletcher**, Chad Kendall, Michael K. Price, and Arthur Vu. (2026) Experiencing carbon pricing, NBER No. 34559, under review at *Journal of the European Economic Association*.

Cherry, Todd L., **Ian M. Fletcher**, George Loewenstein, Mary F. Evans, Paul J. Ferraro, David Finnoff, Jacob P. Hochard, Bryan Leonard, Peter Martinsson, James J. Murphy, Jason F. Shogren, Leaf Van Boven, Daan van Soest, and Christian Vossler. (2026) The Curse of Intangibility for Public Policy, under review at *Science (Policy Forum)*.

Fletcher, Ian M., David Finnoff, and Sean K. Bertalot (2026) Recovering Ecological Value from Observed Management: A Non-Autonomous Model of Jackson Lake, under review at *Land Economics*.

WORKING PAPERS

Fatchen, Faith, **Ian M. Fletcher**, Udit Karna, Faisal Kattan, and John A. List. (2026) From Survival to Learning: The Evolution of Early Childhood Investment Over the Development Cycle, Working Paper.

Fletcher, Ian M., Todd L. Cherry, and George Loewenstein. (2026) Natural Disasters and the Intangibility of Risk Reduction: Theory and Experimental Evidence, Working Paper.

Fletcher, Ian M. (2026) Education Spending and the Intangibility of Investing: Theory and Experimental Evidence, Working Paper.

PRESENTATIONS

2026: Workshop in Behavioral and Experimental Economics–Buenos Aires, Argentina.

Appalachian Environmental and Experimental Economics Workshop, Boone, NC.

2025: Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Conference, Santa Ana Pueblo, NM.

Colorado State University and University of Wyoming Research Symposium, Fort Collins, CO.

2024: Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Washington, DC.

Colorado State University and University of Wyoming Research Symposium, Laramie, WY.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Assistant Director, The Teton Behavioral and Economic Science Laboratory, University of Wyoming (*since 2025*)

Research Assistant, “Wyoming Anticipating the Climate-Water Transition (WyACT) and Cascading Challenges to Socio-Environmental Systems in America’s Headwaters” National Science Foundation–EPSCoR/Integrative Activities; Assigned to David Finnoff; \$20,000,000 (*2022–2025*)

TEACHING INTERESTS

Microeconomics, Environmental and Natural Resource Economics, Public Economics, Behavioral and Experimental Economics, Finance, Applied Econometrics, Computational.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Summer 2025 Primary Instructor, Intermediate Microeconomics (undergraduate)

Spring 2025 Primary Instructor, Principles of Finance (undergraduate)

Fall 2024 Guest Lecturer, Experimental Methods (graduate)

Spring 2024 Teaching Assistant, Calculus II (undergraduate)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

R, STATA, MATLAB, L^AT_EX, GitHub, oTree, Qualtrics, Prolific

HONORS AND AWARDS

Three Minute Thesis (3MT) Competition, University Winner, University of Wyoming (*2026*)

Graduate Scholar of the Year, Department of Economics, University of Wyoming (*2026*)

Outstanding PhD Teaching Award, Department of Economics, University of Wyoming (*2025*)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee for: *Journal of Political Economy*, *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*, *Resource and Energy Economics*

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Co-Executive Director and Vice President of Tele-Hope, a suicide prevention non-profit that has raised over \$200,000 and served over 13,000 students (since 2025)

Member, University of Wyoming's Wellness in the WEST Coalition (since 2025)

REFERENCES

Todd L. Cherry, PhD

John S. Bugas Distinguished Professor (committee chair)

Department of Economics, University of Wyoming

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John A. List, PhD

The Kenneth C. Griffin Distinguished Service Professor in Economics and the College

Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics, The University of Chicago

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George Loewenstein, PhD

Herbert A. Simon University Professor of Economics and Psychology

Department of Social and Decision Sciences, Carnegie Mellon University

Email: rlly@andrew.cmu.edu

Jason F. Shogren, PhD

Stroock Chair of Natural Resource Conservation and Management and Professor of Economics

Department of Economics, University of Wyoming

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Jacob Hochard, PhD

Knobloch Associate Professor of Conservation Economics

Haub School of Environment and Natural Resources, University of Wyoming

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